RudCo: Competitive Analysis

Written 2026-10-10 from public pages. RudCo's own offering comes from the RudCo profile, which read the site's code and LinkedIn; RudCo's portal, live pricing and inventory are untested marketing until someone logs in. AI quote tools come from the earlier tools and prices research and are not redone here.

How to read the labels.

- **Yes (claim)** means the vendor says it on its own page. I tested none of it.
- **Snippet only** means the fact came from a search-result summary, because the page itself returned an error (403, timeout) or sat behind a login or paywall.
- **Not stated** means I did not find it on their public pages. It does not show they lack it.
- **No** appears only where a page says so.

Where RudCo can get ahead

Section 1

- **Show where every field came from, line by line.** No competitor I read shows an RFQ line traced to the buyer's own words. The closest are confidence scores (Cassidy) and a low-confidence flag (Proton). Demo: step 3 (parse each line) and step 7 (rep reviews), where clicking a field shows its source words and the gauge table used.
- **Catch certifications the buyer never wrote down.** RudCo already sells "PO→COA/MTR" and "DFARS/REACH/RoHS flags" (RudCo site code). Among competitors I found, mill test reports are download-after-purchase documents (Ryerson, Yarde), and I found no distributor with online ordering that reads a spec and flags the paperwork it implies. The earlier research found no AI quote

tool that does either (tools research). Demo: step 5 (compliance flags with the trigger words highlighted).

- **Ask the buyer one clear question with choices.** Competitors' online flows assume the buyer already knows the exact item (cart, e-quote). The AI tools route open questions to an internal reviewer, and none says it sends the buyer a multiple-choice question (tools research). Demo: step 6 (agent emails the buyer, buyer clicks a choice, the line turns ready).
- **Quote the lines nobody sells online.** The steel shot and grit makers and N.T. Ruddock route buyers to phone or a contact form: N.T. Ruddock ("Call (440) 439-4976 to place an order"), Winoa (e-shops only for seven non-US countries; "Contact us" for quotes), Ervin (no ordering or quote path on the page). RudCo can turn an emailed steel shot request (S-330, SAE J444 sizes) into a draft quote the same hour. Demo: steps 1 to 4 with a steel shot line and an aluminum ingot line in the sample RFQ.
- **Put the benchmark next to the price.** RudCo's own posts say "Opacity is a tax" (LinkedIn). The marketplaces publish indices built from their own trades (Metalshub, snippet only), and I found no distributor quote that names a benchmark and gives a reason per line. Demo: step 5 (a price beside a named, dated benchmark). Claim only "tracks published metal cost plus RudCo's margin", not "cheapest".
- **Keep the rep in charge, which is also RudCo's stated view.** Some AI tools auto-send above a confidence threshold (AIQuote). The founder says "People still want to deal with people" (Digital Journal). Demo: step 7 (rep approves) and step 8 (rep sends on the buyer's thread).

Two angles are not open. Reading a messy RFQ into a draft quote is already sold to other distributors (tools research), and Klöckner announced an AI app for "fully-automatic handling of orders and enquiries" on 11 Mar 2020 (Kallanish, headline only). "Learns the buyer's shorthand" is claimed by Proton. Our edge there is showing the source of each reading (step 9, stretch).

What competitors offer that RudCo does not (or does not visibly)

- **Published prices with checkout.** Online Metals, Reliance's FastMetals, Nox Metals and Bryzos sell with prices shown online. Reliance said FastMetals "provides instant pricing, same-day shipping, no minimum order quantity" (Reliance press release, 2020-02-19). Nox says customers get "instant quotes through a customer portal called GONDOR" (investor write-up, a claim). RudCo claims "dynamic pricing" but its page data shows a price of "0" on every item (RudCo profile), and its quote form promises a reply "within 24 hours."
- **Cutting and processing.** Olympic Steel lists "cutting to length, stretch leveling, and welding" (Olympic Steel). Central Steel & Wire (a Ryerson company) lists coil processing, laser cutting and saw cutting (CSW). Metal Supermarkets advertises "Any Metal Cut to Size" (Metal Supermarkets). Klöckner offers "cutting to burning" for plate (Kloeckner Metals). RudCo's listed products (ingot, shot, billets, cathode) show no processing.
- **Physical branches and local pickup.** Metal Supermarkets cites "over 135 metal store locations across North America"; Olympic Steel cites "53 strategically located sales and warehouse locations"; Klöckner cites "50+ branches" (same pages). RudCo is three people in New York (profile).
- **Self-serve documents and order status in an account.** Ryerson.com lists "real-time inventory, electronic mill test reports" and "e-quote, shopping lists, duplicate orders, 24/7" (CSW page describing Ryerson.com). Yarde's login lets customers "obtain mill certs, check your order status and history," and its shipping notice program emails when material ships (Yarde). Nox claims "self-service certificate delivery" and "real-time order tracking." RudCo's site ties documents to the PO but does not say buyers can download them or reorder.
- **Mill test reports on request at checkout.** Online Metals lets buyers request an MTR per line item in the cart and emails it as a PDF with the shipment notice (MTR page, read in Chrome).
- **Credit and payment products.** Klöckner links "Kloeckner Pay" and "Apply for Credit." Bryzos offered near-immediate credit through Fundbox (PYMNTS, 2022, snippet only). Metalshub added credit insurance in 2018 (EIT RawMaterials, snippet only). N.T. Ruddock and Metal Supermarkets link credit applications. RudCo's terms mention invoices and past-due charges; I found no credit offer (profile).

- **ERP and EDI integration.** Metalshub lists "Seamless ERP integrations," and ERP integration is in its Professional plan from "€60k+/year" (Metalshub, pricing). A third-party summary says Reliance and Olympic customers order through EDI and portals (snippet only; Porter's summary). The AI tools Avent, Hexa and Mercura write quotes into the buyer's or seller's ERP (tools research). RudCo: not stated.
- **Multi-supplier price discovery.** Bryzos routes a buyer's uploaded RFQ to sellers who respond with quotes (Metal Center News, 2019, snippet only). Metalshub runs spot and index-based long-term contracts. RudCo sells from its own sourcing, so it shows one price.
- **Technical services for abrasives.** Winoa's W Care arm lists "consulting, testing, training, maintenance and repairs, machine upgrades" and application specialists (Winoa). Ervin lists "World Class Tech Support" and a spot check kit (Ervin). RudCo: not stated.
- **Quality system badges.** N.T. Ruddock lists ISO 9001:2015; Winoa says all "9 sites" are accredited and cites ISO 50001 and an EcoVadis Silver medal. RudCo: not stated.
- **A scale and track record.** Klöckner's XOM Materials lists about 50 distributors and 20,000 products (Klöckner press release). NowPurchase claims about 100 foundries on its platform, 70 transacting monthly (Entrackr and others, snippet only). RudCo names no customer (profile).

Comparison table

Section 3

Sources are linked in each row's first cell and where a cell needs its own. Cells with no link use the row's sources.

Table 1: ordering, speed, inventory, integration, AI

Company	Instant online price	Quote turnaround promise	Catalog breadth	Live inventory	Portal and reorder
RudCo (profile, site code)	Yes (claim, untested; page data shows price "0")	Yes: reply "within 24 hours"	Steel shot and grit, garnet, aluminum oxide; P1020 aluminum, 356 alloys, titanium, billets and plate, copper cathode, master alloys	Yes (claim, untested)	Portal claimed (untested); reorder Not stated
N.T. Ruddock	Not stated (cart exists; orders by phone)	Not stated	Abrasives, metals, blasting parts, equipment	Not stated (the table text says "2 Warehouses In Florida"; the home page banner says "Warehouses Nationwide")	Not stated
Winoa / W Abrasives	Not stated for the US (e-shops for Brazil, Czech	Not stated	Steel shot and grit, stainless, cut wire,	Not stated	E-shops only in the countries above

Company	Instant online price	Quote turnaround promise	Catalog breadth	Live inventory	Portal and reorder
	Republic, Italy, Mexico, Poland, South Korea, Thailand)		peening media		
Ervin Industries	Not stated	Not stated	Steel shot and grit, stainless, metal powders	Not stated	Not stated
Metal Tech (closest match: Metaltec Steel Abrasive)	Not stated (home page has a "Request Quote" link and a phone number; no cart or price list)	Not stated	Steel shot and steel grit (cast steel shot to SAE J2175, grit to SAE J1993, per the page)	Not stated	Not stated

Company	Instant online price	Quote turnaround promise	Catalog breadth	Live inventory	Portal and reorder
Ryerson, now with Olympic Steel (merger closed 2026-02-13, snippet only)	"Create E-Quote" button after current pricing (CSW page). Ryerson.com home page: "Buy metal online, real time, anytime" (Ryerson); I did not check whether prices show before login	Not stated	Steel, stainless, aluminum, tool steel, alloy, brass, copper and bronze; "70,000+ products" (Ryerson)	Yes (claim): "real-time inventory"	Yes: shopping lists, duplicate orders, 24/7; bulk upload of a CSV or Excel parts list in the cart; quotes can be converted to orders at checkout (Ryerson FAQ)
Reliance / FastMetals	Yes (claim, 2020): "instant pricing"; fastmetals.com now loads Yarde, whose home page shows no price, though its Drop Zone lists remnant prices "for orders placed	Not stated	"over 100,000 products" across its service center network (claim)	Not stated	Yarde has a login to "obtain mill certs, check your order status and history" (Yarde)

Company	Instant online price	Quote turnaround promise	Catalog breadth	Live inventory	Portal and reorder
	over the Internet"				
Online Metals (read in Chrome, 2026-10-10)	Yes: a 6061 aluminum angle listing showed "$4.58 for 1" with a size picker, "Custom Cut" and "Add To Cart" before sign-in	Not stated	"over 85,000 different cut sizes" and "seven pickup locations" (cut-to-size page); listings filter by spec, DFARS and domestic, and by seller	Not stated	Sign-in and cart; MTRs are requested per line item in the cart or last checkout step (MTR page)
Metal Supermarkets	Not stated ("place an online order today"; prices vary by store, snippet only)	"quick quote" from a store rep	"over 8,000 types, shapes and grades"	Not stated	"Pro+" account for unifying procurement

Company	Instant online price	Quote turnaround promise	Catalog breadth	Live inventory	Portal and reorder
Klöckner Metals and XOM Materials	"Get a Quote" form; 2017 site let customers "see inventory and request a quote" (2017 article)	Not stated	XOM lists about 20,000 products across about 50 distributors	2017 site: yes	Not stated
Metalshub	Marketplace negotiation; no fixed price list	Not stated	Metals and ferroalloys, raw materials	"inventory" is listed as a use case	Contract and data tools
NowPurchase (snippet only: G2 listing and others)	Price and stock through a WhatsApp bot (claim)	Not stated	Foundry inputs: ferro alloys, additives, scrap, pig iron	Via the bot (claim)	Not stated
Bryzos (snippet only, 2019 and 2022 coverage)	Yes (claim): "instant pricing" tool	Not stated	Carbon, stainless, aluminum	Sellers list inventory	Buyer RFQ upload and compare

Company	Instant online price	Quote turnaround promise	Catalog breadth	Live inventory	Portal and reorder
Xometry (snippet only; custom parts, adjacent)	Yes (claim): instant online quotes	Not stated	20+ materials per its EU site	Not stated	Not stated
Nox Metals (own site, read in Chrome, 2026-10-10; earlier: investor write-up, claims)	Yes (claim): the quote page says "see your price instantly" after you pick alloy and dimensions; I did not enter dimensions, so I saw no price	Yes (claim): "Your ship date is shown with your instant quote, before you order"	Aluminum plate and bar cut to size; stainless round bar (304, 316, 17-4 PH, 416)	Not stated	Yes: Log in, Cart, "Upload PO", "Add part numbers" on the quote page
CloudForge (snippet only: Pulse 2)	Not stated; says it is "not a marketplace"	Not stated	Not applicable (sales and procurement software)	Not stated	CRM-style customer and vendor management

Company	Instant online price	Quote turnaround promise	Catalog breadth	Live inventory	Portal and reorder
AI quote tools: Avent, Hexa, Mercura, Proton and others	Not applicable (they sit behind a supplier)	Yes (claims): "minutes instead of days" (Mercura, Hexa)	Supplier's own catalog	Via ERP	Rep approval screen

Table 2: documents, processing, delivery, credit, price transparency, compliance

Company	Certs and traceability (MTR, COA, DFARS, origin)	Processing	Delivery promise	Credit terms	Pri tra or
RudCo (profile)	Yes (claim): PO tied to COA and MTR, lot and heat number, country of origin; "DFARS/REACH/RoHS flags"	Not stated	Yes (claim): "Stocked lines ship in 24–48 hours"	Not stated (terms mention invoices)	Rh ("C ta "d pr un be sh
N.T. Ruddock	ISO 9001:2015 listed; COA and MTR not stated	Not stated	Not stated	Credit application link	Nc
Winoa / W Abrasives	ISO 9001 at all sites (claim); COA not stated	Yes: W Care services such as shot peening and finishing	"dispatch from the nearest site" (claim)	Not stated	Nc
Ervin Industries	No certification listed on the page	Not stated	"LOCATIONS NATIONWIDE"; terms not stated	Not stated	Nc

Company	Certs and traceability (MTR, COA, DFARS, origin)	Processing	Delivery promise	Credit terms	Pri tra or
Metal Tech (closest match: Metaltec Steel Abrasive)	Not stated; page cites SAE J2175 (shot) and SAE J1993 (grit); it has a "Documents" page I did not open	Not stated	Not stated	Not stated	A "St Su sh th pa NE fo Se 20 pr
Ryerson / Olympic Steel	Electronic mill test reports in the account (CSW page); Olympic has a "Certifications" page I did not read. Ryerson's FAQ says mill test reports are in the Orders section, with a link per item once the order has shipped, for online and sales-rep orders (Ryerson FAQ); Ryerson lists ISO certificates on its Certification & Compliance page	Yes: cutting to length, stretch leveling, welding; laser, saw and coil work at CSW; Ryerson.com lists sheet and coil, plate, and bar, tube and structural processing, plus	Not stated officially; one third-party site says same-day or next-day windows (unreliable, snippet only)	"Credit Application" link on Ryerson.com (Ryerson)	Nc

Company	Certs and traceability (MTR, COA, DFARS, origin)	Processing	Delivery promise	Credit terms	Pri tra or
		fabrication (Ryerson)			
Reliance / FastMetals	Press release does not mention certifications; sister brand Yarde offers mill certs after login	Standard or custom dimensions (claim); Yarde lists sheet cut to length, plate sawing, plasma, waterjet and laser cutting, band sawing, machining and heat treating (Yarde services)	Yes (claim, 2020): "same-day shipping," ships nationwide	Not stated	"c pr m

Company	Certs and traceability (MTR, COA, DFARS, origin)	Processing	Delivery promise	Credit terms	Pri tra or
Online Metals (read in Chrome, 2026-10-10)	MTRs are requested per line item in the cart or last checkout step and emailed as PDFs with the shipment notice; Online Metals writes its own Certificate of Conformance when no MTR exists (MTR page). The "free of charge" wording from the earlier search summary is not on that page. Listings filter by DFARS and domestic	Yes: cut to size (cut-to-size page)	Yes (claim): same-day shipping on custom cuts; six shipping locations reach 99% of the US in one to two days (search summary, not rechecked)	Not stated	Ye sh th be in 1" x in. an
Metal Supermarkets	MTR not stated	Yes: "light processing services"	Not stated	Credit applications through each store (snippet only: York form)	Nc
Klöckner	Not stated	Yes: "cutting to burning" for plate	"delivery speed" cited, no promise	Yes: "Kloeckner Pay," "Apply for Credit"	Nc

Company	Certs and traceability (MTR, COA, DFARS, origin)	Processing	Delivery promise	Credit terms	Pri tra or
Metalshub	Not stated	"Tolling Solution" listed	Not stated (2018 trucking quotes, snippet only)	Credit insurance and financing (2018, snippet only)	Ye inc "b re bic tra
NowPurchase (snippet only)	On-ground inspection and quality checks (claim)	Not stated	Not stated	Financing options (claim, no terms)	"re pr thr bc
Bryzos (snippet only)	Not stated	Not stated	Not stated	Yes: Fundbox credit for qualified buyers	"M Pr Inc
Xometry (snippet only; UK page)	Certificates of compliance, raw material certificates, RoHS (UK)	Yes: fabrication	Not stated	Not stated	Nc
Nox Metals (own site, read in Chrome, 2026-10-10; claims)	"Every order ships with mill certs and full traceability documentation"; "DFARS compliant domestic melt material available	Yes: aluminum plate and bar cut to size; standard cut tolerance of	Ship date shown with the instant quote; "real-time order tracking" is from the	Not stated	Nc on "$ mi

Company	Certs and traceability (MTR, COA, DFARS, origin)	Processing	Delivery promise	Credit terms	Pri tra or
	across all alloys" (quote page); the quote form has a "Compliance" column	minus 0.00 and plus 0.125 inches	earlier write-up		
CloudForge	Not stated	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable	Nc ap
AI quote tools	Not stated by any tool read; badges describe the vendor's own security	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable	Nc

Note on "Nox Metals": noxmetals.com is a Montana welding shop and is a different company (noxmetals.com). The metals company with the instant quote tool is at noxmetals.co, which I read in Chrome. The earlier write-up of it is here.

Profiles by competitor group

Section 4

Traditional distributors and abrasive makers

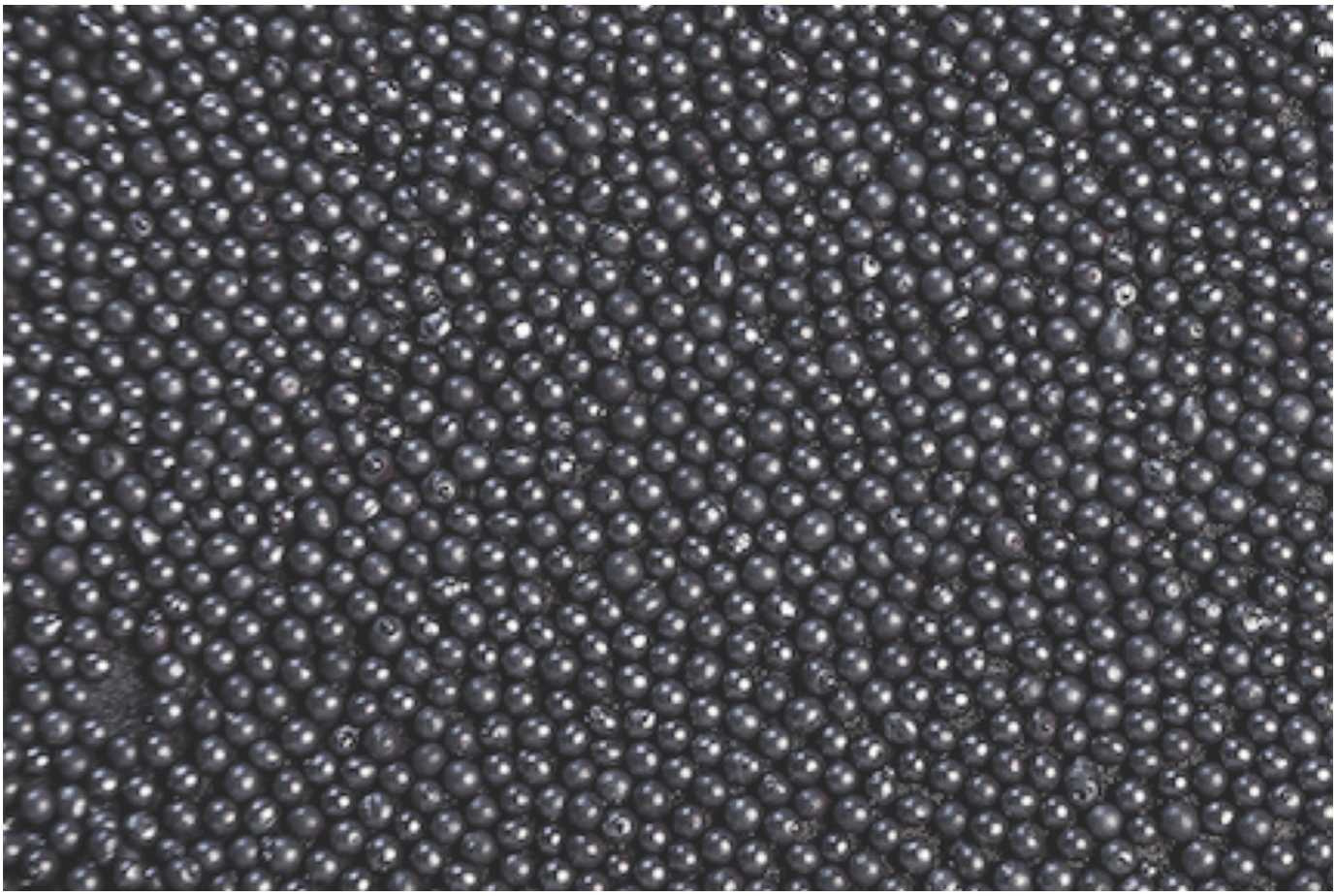
- **N.T. Ruddock** sells blasting abrasives, metals and equipment from two Florida warehouses, takes orders by phone, and collects quote requests through a contact form (N.T. Ruddock). The profile notes a possible link to RudCo's founder

that is unconfirmed (RudCo profile). What it has that RudCo does not show: ISO 9001:2015, a credit application, and a long history (blasting abrasives since 1951 per its About page).



The home page banner: piles of blasting abrasives in several colors, the line "Our Abrasives Hold Up Under Pressure", a sales email, "Warehouses Nationwide" and a phone number, from N.T. Ruddock site.

- **Winoa / W Abrasives** is a maker with a distributor network of "240 agents and distributors" and a services arm (Winoa). RudCo's FAQ names Winoa and Metal Tech as the brands its steel shot is "a direct alternative" to (RudCo profile). Winoa wins on testing, technical support and sites in many countries.
- **Ervin Industries** makes shot, grit and metal powders and lists technical support and nationwide locations (Ervin). Its page has no ordering path. SurfacePrep carries Ervin and W Abrasives (snippet only).



A close-up photo of dark, round steel shot pellets from Ervin's AMASTEEL Shot product page, from Ervin site.

- **Metal Tech** did not load for me, so I have no evidence about it.

Large service centers

- **Ryerson and Olympic Steel** merged on 2026-02-13, which makes the combined company the second-largest North American metals service center (Pulse 2, snippet only). Ryerson.com offers real-time inventory, electronic mill test reports, e-quotes and reorder tools (CSW page). Olympic offers deep processing (Olympic Steel).

Bundle of polished metal tubes

The home page hero photo, a bundle of polished metal tubes, shown beside the headline "Buy metal online, anytime", from Ryerson site.

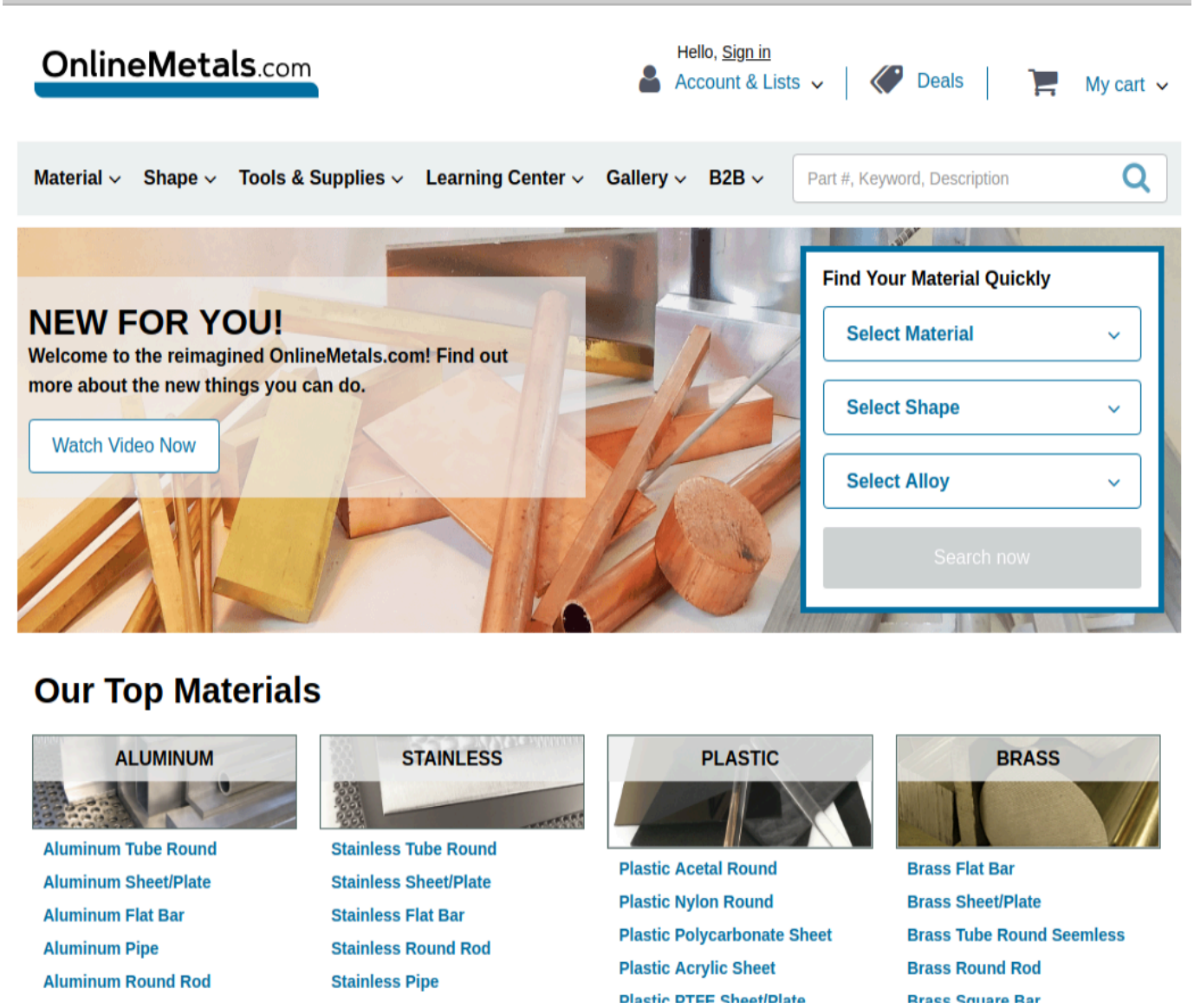
- **Reliance Steel** launched FastMetals in 2020 for small buyers: instant pricing, same-day shipping, no minimum (Reliance). The fastmetals.com address now

redirects to Yarde, another Reliance brand, so I cannot say whether FastMetals still runs as a separate store (Yarde).

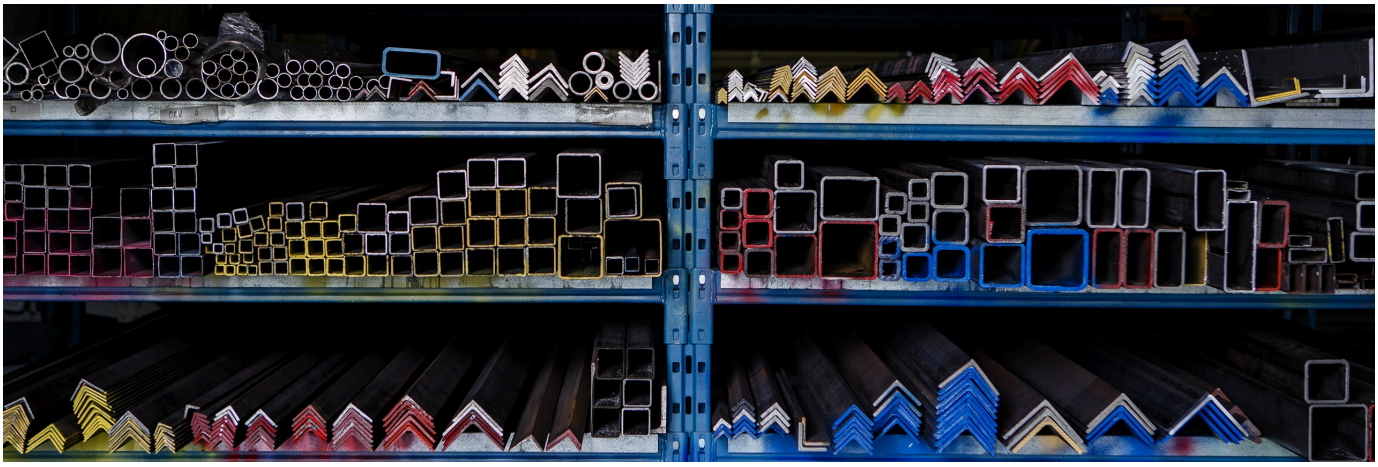


The home page photo of wrapped metal plates stacked on warehouse racks. Yarde is the Reliance brand that fastmetals.com now loads, from Yarde site.

- **Online Metals** and **Metal Supermarkets** serve small orders. Online Metals sells cut-to-size with prices shown before sign-in, and sends MTRs on request (Online Metals). Metal Supermarkets has 135 franchised stores and routes credit and quotes through them (Metal Supermarkets).



The home page: a "Find Your Material Quickly" box with Select Material, Select Shape and Select Alloy menus beside a photo of copper, brass and aluminum stock, with top material categories below, from Online Metals site.



A home page photo of store shelves holding tube, angle and bar stock, from Metal Supermarkets site.

- **Klöckner** runs a quote form, credit and payment tools, and a separate marketplace (XOM Materials). It also announced an AI order and enquiry app in 2020 (Kloeckner Metals, Kallanish headline).
- None of these pages says anything about AI reading emailed RFQs, other than Klöckner's 2020 headline. I found no AI quoting announcement from Ryerson, Reliance or Olympic (search, snippet only).

Marketplaces and procurement platforms

- **Metalshub** (Düsseldorf) sells software for buyers, sellers and tollers, priced by annual spend from "€5k/year" (pricing). It lists price discovery and ERP integration, but not AI (Metalshub).



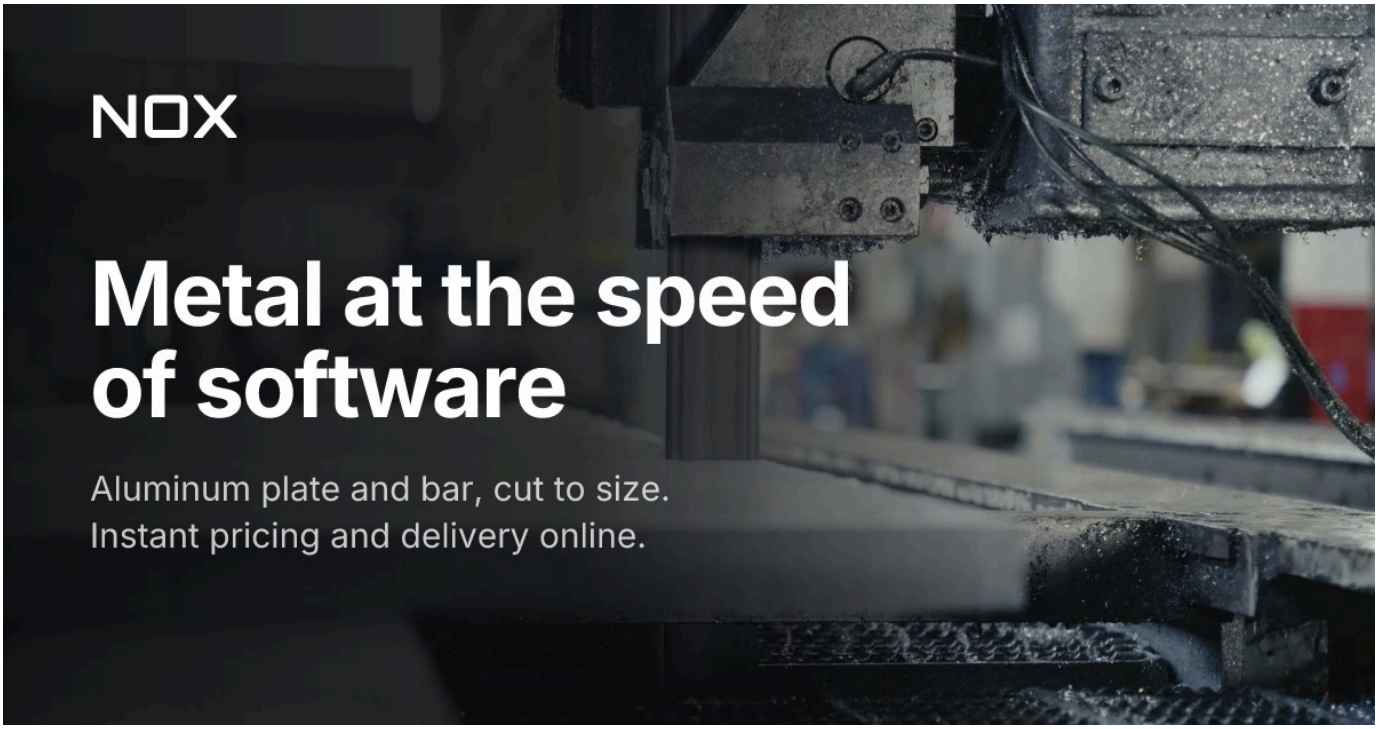
The home page share image: the metalshub logo and the line "Unlocking supply chain value" over a darkened photo of a person using a laptop. It is a brand image, not a product screen, from Metalshub site.

- **NowPurchase** (India) serves foundries with raw materials, quality checks and financing (claims, snippet only).
- **Bryzos** (US) lets a buyer upload an RFQ and collects seller quotes (2019 coverage, snippet only).



The site's share image: the Bryzos logo and the line "The go-to metals marketplace". It is a brand image, not a product screen, from Bryzos site.

- **XOM Materials** (Klöckner) is a white-label platform for distributors (press release).
- **Nox Metals** is a plate service center with its own quoting software (investor write-up, claims).



The home page share image: "Metal at the speed of software. Aluminum plate and bar, cut to size. Instant pricing and delivery online," over a photo of a machine and metal plate. The quote page is a table with shape, alloy, temper, compliance, dimensions and quantity columns and a ZIP code box for cost and date, from Nox Metals site.

- **CloudForge** sells to service centers and says it is not a marketplace (Pulse 2, snippet only).
- **Xometry** is a custom-parts marketplace. It offers certificates, but its instant quote covers manufactured parts, so it is an adjacent comparison and not a metals supplier like RudCo (Xometry UK, snippet only).

AI quote tools for distributors

Avent, Hexa, Mercura and Proton turn emailed RFQs into draft quotes with a rep approving, and most write into an ERP. No tool read shows field-level provenance, buyer-facing questions, or spec-implied certification flags. Full table, vendor claims and caveats are in the tools research.



The page's share image: the proton.ai logo on a dark blue background. It is a brand image, not a product screen, from Proton site.

What our demo should show

Section 5

Maps to the steps in WORKFLOW.md. The demo uses a sample catalog and sample benchmark data, labeled as such on screen.

Opportunity	Workflow step	Can the demo show it today?	Notes
Source of every field, with the gauge table named	3 (parse) and 7 (review)	Yes	Core build. The stainless "16 ga" reading to 0.0625 in is the clearest example.
Spec-implied certification flags with trigger words	5 (price, flag, assumptions)	Yes	Rules and keyword triggers. Include one defense ship-to line to show a context-based flag. RudCo already promises DFARS and MTR documents.
Choice-based question to the buyer, one click	6 (questions)	Yes, if Hirsh's email click flow lands	WORKFLOW decision W2 says buttons work with no login.
Quote an abrasives line and an ingot line	1 (sample RFQ), 3, 4	Yes	Add steel shot S-330 and P1020 or 356 aluminum to the sample RFQ so the demo matches RudCo's catalog. Depends on W4 (which catalog the demo uses).
Price beside a named, dated benchmark with a reason	5	Partly	FRED's steel and aluminum producer price series are free (tools research, Part B). Abrasives have no public benchmark I found, so a shot line needs a clearly labeled sample price or a "no benchmark, line held" state.

Opportunity	Workflow step	Can the demo show it today?	Notes
Rep approves, agent replies on the buyer's thread	7 and 8	Yes	Matches the founder's "better information for the conversation" view.
Learns the buyer's shorthand, with source	9 (stretch)	Only if time allows	Contested by Proton, so show the visible source of the reading.

Things competitors have that the demo cannot honestly show today: live inventory, delivery promises, credit terms, cutting, ERP or EDI integration, and order tracking. Do not imply them. If a judge asks, the honest answer is that the demo covers quote preparation, and RudCo's portal and fulfillment sit behind it.

One pitch line the evidence supports: published-price shops answer "I know the exact item." RudCo's buyers send emails where the item is written five ways, and the demo is the step that turns that email into something priced. That line is an inference from the sources above, not a finding.

Gaps

Section 6

What I could not verify, and where I looked.

- **RudCo's portal and pricing.** Nobody logged in. Instant pricing, live inventory and ordering are claims in the site code (profile).

- **Metal Tech.** The earlier attempt refused the connection (ECONNREFUSED). RudCo's FAQ names "Metal Tech" with no web address. In Chrome I opened metaltecsteel.com (Metaltec Steel Abrasive Company, a steel shot and grit maker), which loaded, and I used it for the Metal Tech cells. I could not confirm it is the company RudCo means. It lists a "Request Quote" link, a monthly steel surcharge, and no cart.
- **Online Metals.** Its pages returned 403 to the fetch tool but loaded in Chrome, where I read the home page, a product listing, and the MTR, cut-to-size and defense pages. Instant prices show before sign-in. Not checked: the checkout steps, the shipping promise, and the "free MTR" and "same-day shipping" wording from the earlier search summary, which are not on the pages I read.
- **Ryerson and Reliance first-party pages.** Ryerson.com loaded in Chrome (the fetch tool got empty content). I read its home page, FAQ and Certification & Compliance page. Not checked: whether prices show before login, delivery promises, and EDI. Reliance's current portal and EDI details were not found on an official page. Olympic Steel's home page said nothing about online ordering, and its portal could not be confirmed.
- **FastMetals today.** The 2020 press release is the only first-party source about FastMetals itself. In Chrome, fastmetals.com loads Yarde, whose home page greets "Rotax and FastMetals Customers" and points them to its Drop Zone remnant store or a phone number. I cannot say whether FastMetals still runs as a separate store.
- **Delivery promises** for Ryerson, Reliance and Olympic: no official source found. One third-party site claims next-day windows and is unreliable.
- **Metalshub fees and certificates.** The FAQ page showed questions without answers. The seller-paid success fee comes from 2018 and 2019 coverage, and the current pricing page shows subscription plans instead. How certificates are handled was not found.
- **NowPurchase** pages showed only a tagline. All detail is from directory listings and press (snippet only).
- **Bryzos and Xometry** are from search summaries (2019 and 2022 coverage for Bryzos; a UK page for Xometry). Current US features are unconfirmed.
- **Klöckner Assistant.** I have the headline and date (11 Mar 2020) only. The article is paywalled, so I cannot say if it drafts quotes or only handles orders, or

whether it is still running.

- **DFARS online ordering.** One search for distributors that pair online ordering with DFARS documentation found manufacturers, fastener suppliers and solicitations, and no distributor (search, snippet only). That is one search. Treat "no distributor does this" as unverified.
- **Page summaries.** The fetch tool summarizes pages with a small model. I quoted phrases it returned, but I did not read raw HTML for any page except as noted in the RudCo profile.
- **Searches run.** Reliance and Olympic online ordering and EDI; Klöckner XOM and digital; Klöckner Assistant; Ryerson portal and mill test reports; Olympic portal and processing; Online Metals MTR and cutting; Metalshub marketplace; NowPurchase; Xometry materials; Winoa certifications; Bryzos; AI quoting at Ryerson, Reliance, Olympic; DFARS distributors; Ryerson-Olympic merger; CloudForge; Metal Supermarkets credit; steel shot certificates. Reddit was not used.

Sources

Section 7

- RudCo: profile, site code, LinkedIn post, "Opacity is a tax", Digital Journal interview
- Our product: WORKFLOW, PRD, AI quote tools and price benchmarks
- Read directly: N.T. Ruddock, N.T. Ruddock About, Winoa, Ervin, Metal Supermarkets, Olympic Steel, Central Steel & Wire FAQ (Ryerson.com features), Yarde, Reliance FastMetals press release, Kloeckner Metals, Kloeckner Metals 2017 article, XOM Materials press release, Metalshub, Metalshub pricing, Nox Metals investor write-up, CloudForge press release (via search), Online Metals home, Online Metals product listing, Online Metals MTR, Online Metals cut to size, Online Metals defense, Ryerson.com, Ryerson FAQ, Ryerson Certification & Compliance, Yarde Drop Zone, Yarde services, Metaltec Steel Abrasive, Nox Metals, Nox Metals quote page, Nox Metals quality policy

- Snippet only: Kallanish on Klöckner's assistant, Ryerson-Olympic merger (Willkie), Pulse 2 on the merger, Ryerson Q1 2026 call, Ryerson earnings transcripts, Porter's summary, Olympic Steel, Porter's summary, Reliance, Ryerson marketing mix (unreliable), Metalshub seed round post, EIT RawMaterials on Metalshub, NowPurchase on Entrackr, CB Insights, Metals Hub vs NowPurchase, Metal Center News on Bryzos, PYMNTS on Bryzos, Xometry EU, Xometry UK sheet metal, Pulse 2 on CloudForge, Metal Supermarkets York credit form, SurfacePrep W Abrasives, DFARS specialty metals overview
- AI quote tools cited (see the tools research for the full list): Proton, Cassidy, AIQuote
- Could not load: noxmetals.com is a different company (noxmetals.com); the metals company is at noxmetals.co and loaded. Metal Tech's original address refused the connection; see the Gaps section for the closest match I read.